PIANO BUTLER · DRAFT COLLECTION

Rhythm & Time

Everything made so far for rhythm: the Handbook chapter, the Workbook, the activity bank, free printables and thirteen games.

Draft · November 2026 · 47 pages

Contents

Page numbers below are positions in this collection.

1 **The Handbook · Part II: Time** 3–10
Opener and 7 topic pages: pulse and bar, notes and rests, note lengths, time signatures, compound and irregular time, groups and upbeats, off the beat

2 **The Workbook · Time** 11–23
Learn and Use pages for each topic, review, progress chart and answers

3 **Activity bank · Rhythm steps 1–3** 24–30
22 tagged activities with level, stars and answers

4 **Free printables · Rhythm** 31–34
4 sheets for teachers to print and share

5 **Rhythm games 1–4** 35–38
Colour by beats, secret code, rhythm bingo, race to the double bar

6 **Rhythm games 5–13** 39–47
Memory cards, dominoes, word search, rhythm sudoku, one-beat maze, dice composer, rhythm café, escape room, noughts and crosses

Each part keeps its own page numbers inside, as it will when printed on its own.

PART II

Time

Music moves through time. Underneath it runs a steady **pulse**; the pulse is grouped into **bars**; and every note and rest takes a measured share of it. This part goes from that big picture down to the length of a single note.

1 **Pulse** — the steady beat underneath

›

2 **Bar** — beats in groups of 2, 3 or 4

›

3 **Time signature** — how many beats, and which note is one beat

›

4 **Note values** — how long each sound lasts

›

5 **Rhythm** — the pattern of long and short

IN THIS PART

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PART II · TIME · 1

Pulse, tempo and the bar

Under almost every piece runs a **pulse**: a steady beat, like a heartbeat or a clock. Its speed is the **tempo**. Beats are grouped into **bars**, and the first beat of every bar is the strongest.

Tempo

Tempo is measured in beats per minute. A **metronome mark** at the top of the music shows it: ♩ **= 60** means 60 crotchet beats a minute, one beat a second. ♩ **= 120** is twice as fast. Tempo words such as *Andante* and *Allegro* are on page 70.

Strong and weak beats

BEATS	PATTERN	FEELS LIKE
2	**Strong** weak	a march
3	**Strong** weak weak	a waltz
4	**Strong** weak **medium** weak	most songs

Bars and bar lines

SIGN	NAME	MEANING
	bar line	divides the music into bars
	double bar line	marks the end of a section, or a change of key, time signature or tempo
	final bar line	marks the end of the piece
	repeat signs	play the passage between them again; if there is no start sign, go back to the beginning

Counting



Three bars of 3/4. Every beat is counted, even inside a long note: the coral number is where you play, the grey numbers are the beats you hold.

Count aloud at one speed, a little louder on beat 1. With a metronome, start slower than you think and speed up only when the passage is steady.

WATCH OUT

- × Speeding up in the easy bars and slowing down in the hard ones: choose a tempo you can keep in the hardest bar.
- × Counting the notes instead of the beats.

SEE ALSO
Time signatures p. 39 · Tempo words p. 70

PRACTISE IT
Workbook Level 0 · Pulse · Online: Metronome

PART II · TIME · 2

Notes and rests

A note's shape shows how long it lasts: each plain note lasts **half as long** as the one above it. Every note has a **rest** of the same length, a silence counted just as carefully as a sound.

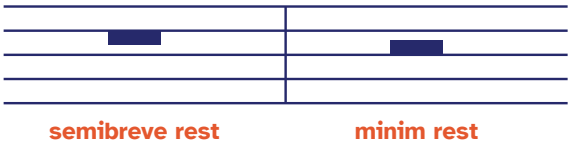
NOTE	REST	NAME	ALSO CALLED	BEATS*	FIRST MET
		**breve**	double whole note	**8**	Level 4
		**dotted semibreve**	dotted whole note	**6**	*Extra*
		**semibreve**	whole note	**4**	Level 0
		**dotted minim**	dotted half note	**3**	Level 0
		**minim**	half note	**2**	Level 0
		**dotted crotchet**	dotted quarter note	**1½**	Level ½
		**crotchet**	quarter note	**1**	Level 0
		**dotted quaver**	dotted eighth note	**¾**	Level 3
		**quaver**	eighth note	**½**	Level 0
		**semiquaver**	sixteenth note	**¼**	Level 2
		**demisemiquaver**	32nd note	**⅛**	*Extra*
		**hemidemisemiquaver**	64th note	**1/16**	*Extra*

* With the crotchet as one beat, as in 2/4, 3/4 and 4/4. *Extra*: beyond Level 8.

Parts of a note

The **head** sits on a line or in a space. A **stem** goes up on the right of the head or down on the left. **Flags** on the stem halve the value each time; groups of quavers are joined by **beams** instead of flags.

Which rest is which?



The semibreve rest **hangs** below the fourth line; the minim rest **sits** on the middle line.

PART II · TIME · 2

How long is a note?

Each row lasts exactly as long as the row above it: the same stretch of time, cut in half again and again.



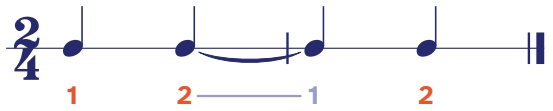
The dot

A dot adds **half the note's value**: a dotted minim lasts 2 + 1 = 3 beats; a dotted crotchet 1 + ½ = 1½. A **double dot** adds half, then a quarter: a double-dotted minim lasts 2 + 1 + ½ = 3½.



The tie

A curve joining two notes **of the same pitch** makes one longer sound: play the first, hold through the second. Ties can cross a bar line, where a dot cannot.



TIE OR SLUR?

The same curve over notes of **different** pitches is a **slur**: play them smoothly joined (legato). Same pitch: a tie. Different pitches: a slur.

Rests in a bar



✓ The silence on beats 3–4 is one minim rest; a whole silent bar takes a semibreve rest, in any time signature.



× In 4/4, a minim rest on beats 2–3 hides the middle of the bar: write two crotchet rests.

SEE ALSO

Time signatures p. 39 · Rhythm p. 41

PRACTISE IT

Workbook Level 0 · Note values · Online: Library › Notes and rests

PART II · TIME · 3

Time signatures

Two numbers at the start of the music. The **top number** says how many counts are in each bar; the **bottom number** says which note gets one count.

The bottom number

BOTTOM	NOTE	ONE COUNT IS A	FIRST MET
2		minim	Level 3
4		crotchet	Level 0
8		quaver	Level 1
16		semiquaver	*Extra*

SIMPLE OR COMPOUND?

In **simple time** each beat divides into **two**. In **compound time** each beat is a dotted note and divides into **three**.

Quick test: a top number of 6, 9 or 12 means compound. Divide it by 3 to find the beats: 6/8 has 2, 9/8 has 3, 12/8 has 4.

Simple time: each beat divides in two

TIME SIGNATURE	EACH BAR HOLDS	FIRST MET
2/4	2 crotchets	Level 0
3/4	3 crotchets	Level 0
4/4 C	4 crotchets (the C sign: common time)	Level 0
2/2 ¢	2 minims (the cut C: cut common time)	Level 3
3/2	3 minims	Level 3
4/2	4 minims	*Extra*
3/8	3 quavers	Level 3

Changing time signature

A new time signature can appear in the middle of a piece, right after a bar line; it holds until the next one. A time signature is written only once, not on every line.

WATCH OUT

- × Reading 6/8 as six beats: at most speeds it moves in two.
- × Mixing up 3/4 and 6/8: both hold six quavers, grouped differently (page 40).

SEE ALSO
Pulse and the bar p. 36 · Compound time p. 40

PRACTISE IT
Workbook Level 0 · Time signatures · Online: Library › Time signatures

PART II · TIME · 3

Compound and irregular time

Compound time has dotted beats that divide into three; irregular time has five or seven counts, grouped unevenly. (9/4, 12/4 and the /16 signatures exist but are rare.)

Compound time

TIME SIGNATURE	EACH BAR HOLDS	FIRST MET
6/8	2 dotted crotchets	Level 1
9/8	3 dotted crotchets	Level 3
12/8	4 dotted crotchets	Level 3
6/4	2 dotted minims	Level 4

Counting 6/8

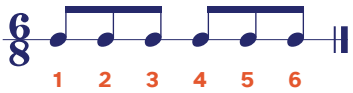


Slowly, count all six quavers. At speed, feel two beats, on 1 and 4: “1 & a, 2 & a”.

3/4 or 6/8?



3/4: six quavers in three twos



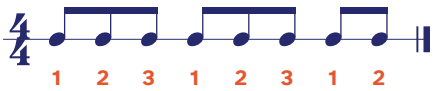
6/8: six quavers in two threes

Irregular time

TIME SIGNATURE	EACH BAR HOLDS	FIRST MET
5/4	5 crotchets: 3 + 2 or 2 + 3	Level 0
7/4	7 crotchets: 4 + 3 or 3 + 4	*Extra*
5/8	5 quavers: 3 + 2 or 2 + 3	*Extra*
7/8	7 quavers: 2 + 2 + 3 or 3 + 2 + 2	*Extra*

UNEVEN GROUPS IN 4/4

Many dances keep 4/4 but group the eight quavers 3 + 3 + 2: “1 2 3, 1 2 3, 1 2”.



PART II · TIME · 4

Rhythm: groups and upbeats

Rhythm is the pattern of long and short sounds over the pulse. The pulse stays steady; the rhythm moves around it. The way notes are grouped on the page shows where the beats are.

Grouping with beams

Beams join the notes of **one beat**, so the beats stay visible. In 4/4 a beam may cover beats 1–2 or 3–4, but never cross the middle of the bar. In compound time, quavers are beamed in threes.



✓ The middle of the bar can be seen.



× A beam across beats 2–3 hides it.

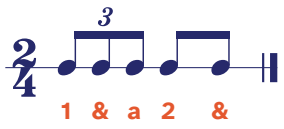
The upbeat (anacrusis)

A piece can begin **before** the first full bar, with one or more notes called an upbeat or anacrusis. The last bar is then short by the same amount, so the two together make one full bar. Count the missing beats in silence before you start.



Count “1 2” silently, then play on 3.

Triplets and duplets



Triplet: three notes in the time of two.

Level 2. Three exactly equal notes.



Duplet: two notes in the time of three, in compound time.

Level 2.

Counting smaller values



Crotchet, two quavers, four semiquavers and a triplet (“1 & a”): one beat each.

PART II · TIME · 4

Rhythm: off the beat

Once the pulse is secure, rhythm can pull against it. Every one of these effects needs a steady beat underneath.

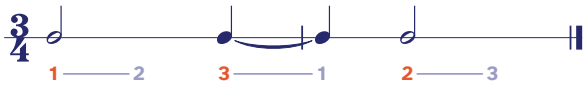
Syncopation



The crotchet starts on “&” and is held through beat 2.

Level 4. Feel beat 2 even though nothing is played on it.

Hemiola



Two bars of 3/4 felt as three minims.

Level 4. Common at cadences in Baroque dances.

Swing Level ½

Common from the first pieces: jazz, blues and many easy modern pieces are marked *swing*. Pairs of quavers are written evenly but played **long–short**, like the first and last notes of a triplet.

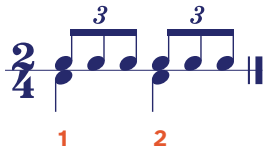


Written



Played

Polyrhythm Level 7



Three against two: a triplet above, two crotchets below, starting together.

Rubato Extra

Time is stretched and then given back, for expression: the music leans into a phrase and catches up after it. The pulse always returns. Marked *rubato*, or simply part of the style in much Romantic music.

WATCH OUT

- × Rushing the short notes after a long one: keep counting inside the long note.
- × Playing a triplet unevenly: three equal notes, not two quick and one long.
- × Letting syncopation drag the pulse: tap the beat with your foot.

SEE ALSO
Notes and rests p. 37 · Words for how to play p. 70

PRACTISE IT
Workbook Levels ½–4 · Rhythm · Online: Rhythm clock

TIME · PULSE AND THE BAR · LEARN

Pulse and the bar

REMEMBER Beats are grouped into bars; beat 1 of every bar is the strongest.

1 Strong beats ★☆☆

Each dot is one beat. Circle the strong beat in every bar. In 4/4, also underline the medium beat.

2/4 ● ● | ● ● |

3/4 ● ● ● | ● ● ● |

4/4 ● ● ● ● | ● ● ● ● |

2 Name the signs ★☆☆

Write the name of each sign and what it tells you.

SIGN	NAME	IT TELLS YOU
		
		
		

3 Count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box: the beat you play, then the beats you hold. The first bar is done.



4 Slow to fast ★☆☆

Number the metronome marks from the slowest (1) to the fastest (4). Then set a metronome to each and walk to it.

♩ = 120	♩ = 60	♩ = 92	♩ = 76
☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

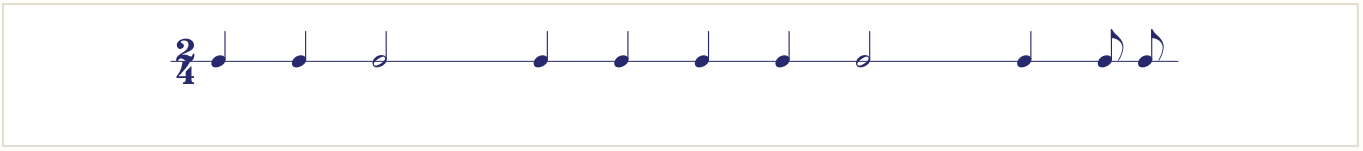
TIME · PULSE AND THE BAR · USE

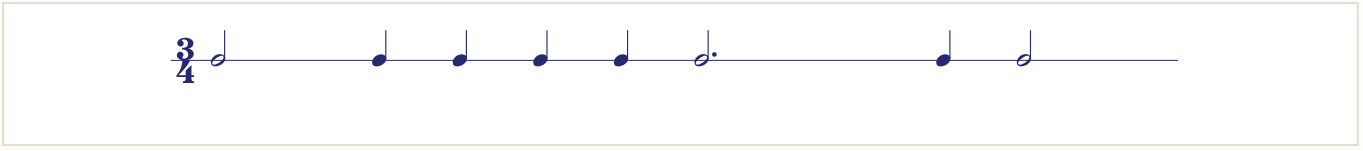
Pulse and the bar

REMEMBER A long note still has every one of its beats counted.

1 Add the bar lines ★★☆

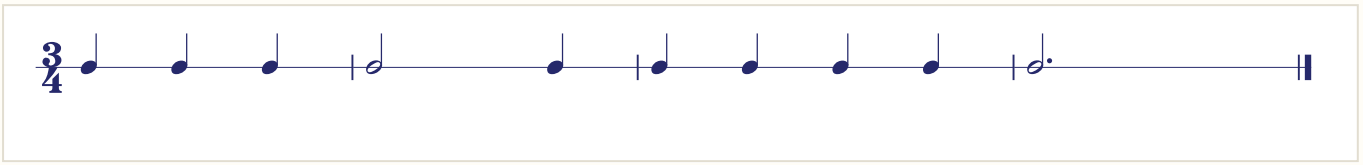
Draw a bar line after every full bar and a final bar line at the end.





2 Spot the mistake ★★☆

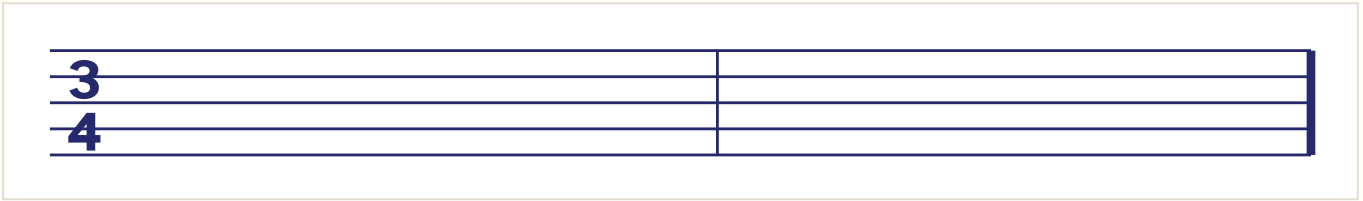
One bar has the wrong number of beats. Circle it and write how many beats it has.



beats in the wrong bar ☐

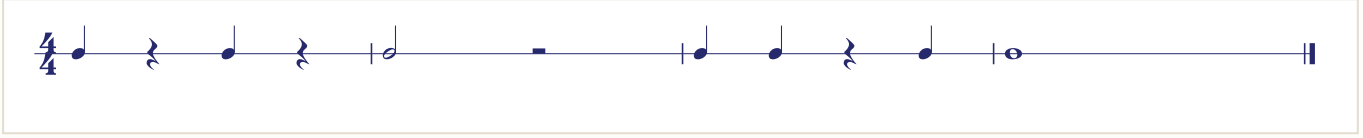
3 Make your own ★★★

Write two bars of 3/4 using crotchets and minims. Clap them while counting, then play them on one note.



4 Clap and count ★☆☆

Set a metronome to ♩ = 60. Clap on the notes, open your hands on the rests, count aloud. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

TIME · NOTES AND RESTS · LEARN

Notes and rests

REMEMBER Each plain note lasts half as long as the one above it; every note has a rest of the same length.

1 Name, beats and rest

★☆☆

Write each note's name and beats (crotchet = 1 beat), then draw the rest of the same length. The first row is done.

NOTE	NAME	BEATS	REST
	semibreve	**4**	
			
			
			
			
			

2 Draw it

★★☆

Draw one note for each length (crotchet = 1 beat).

2 beats	½ beat	3 beats	4 beats

3 The other name

★☆☆

Write the other name for each note. The first is done.

NAME	ALSO CALLED
semibreve	**whole note**
minim	
crotchet	
quaver	
semiquaver	

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

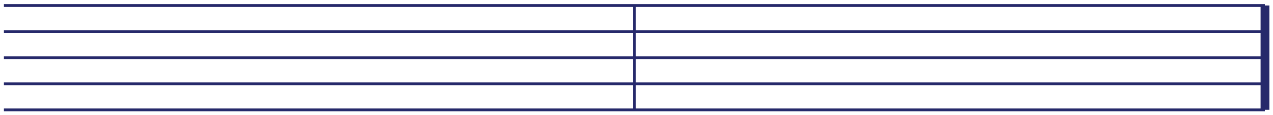
TIME · NOTES AND RESTS · USE

Notes and rests

REMEMBER Below the middle line, stems go up on the right; above it, down on the left.

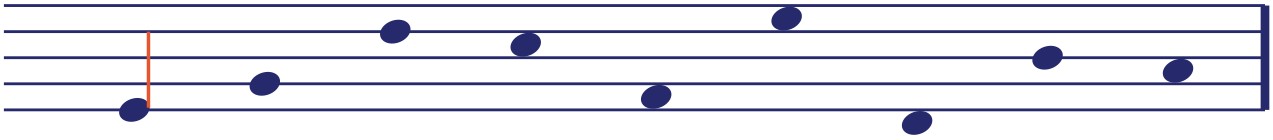
1 Rests on the staff ★☆☆

Draw a semibreve rest in the first bar (it hangs below the fourth line) and a minim rest in the second (it sits on the middle line).



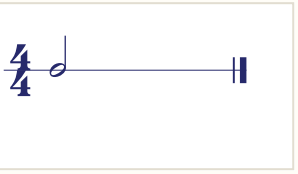
2 Draw the stems ★★☆

Turn every head into a crotchet: add a stem going the right way. The first is done.

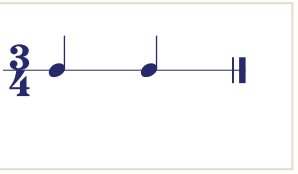


3 Finish with a rest ★★☆

Each bar is short. Complete it with one rest.



rest ☐



rest ☐



rest ☐



rest ☐

4 Which did you hear? ★★☆

Someone claps one rhythm from each row (or play it in the online Library). Circle A, B or C.

A 

B 

C 

A 

B 

C 

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

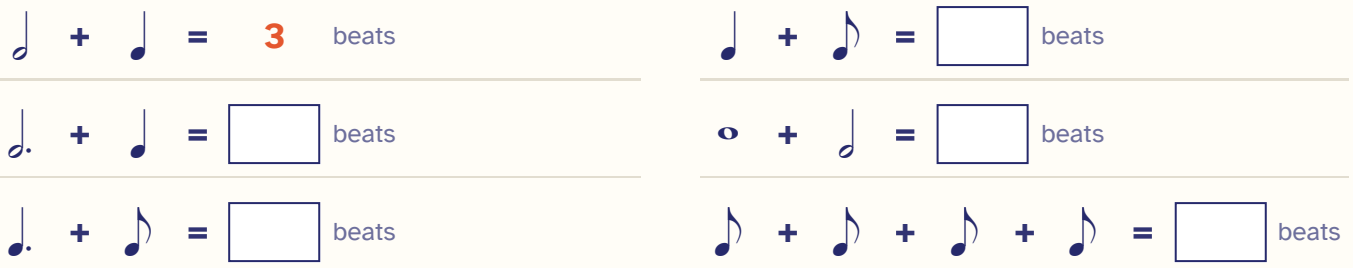
TIME · HOW LONG IS A NOTE? · LEARN

How long is a note?

REMEMBER A dot adds half the note's value; a tie joins two notes of the same pitch into one sound.

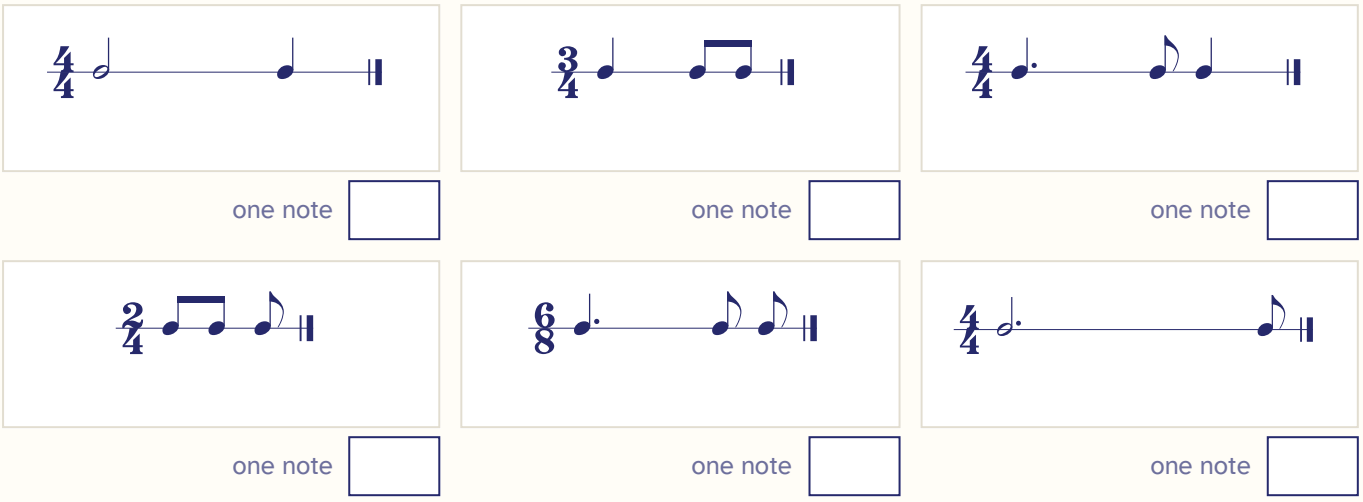
1 Note sums ★☆☆

Add up the beats (crotchet = 1 beat). The first one is done.



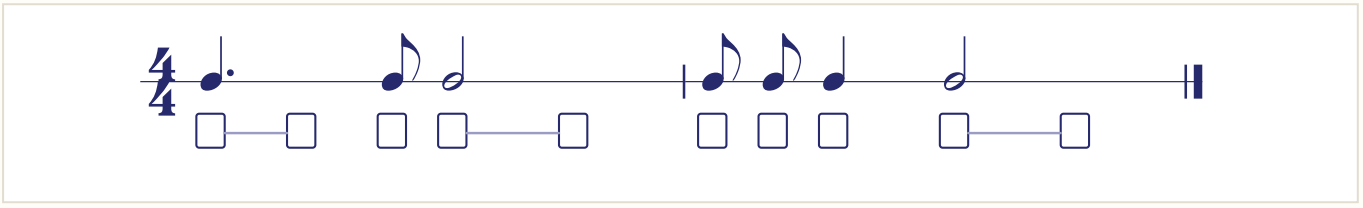
2 Complete the bar ★★☆

Each bar is one note short. Write the one note that completes it.



3 Dots and ties: count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box.



Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · HOW LONG IS A NOTE? · USE

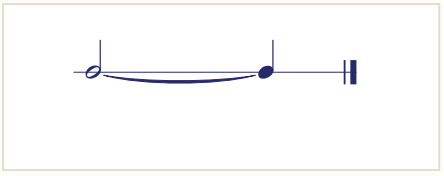
How long is a note?

REMEMBER A tie can cross a bar line; a dot cannot.

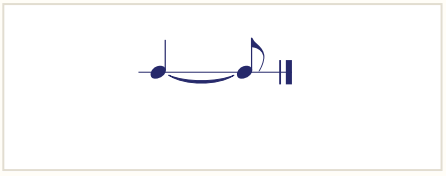
1 Tie or dot?

★★☆

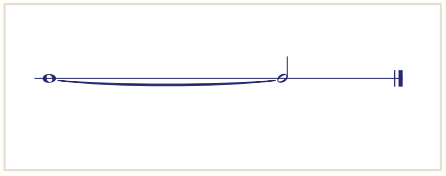
Each tie makes one sound. Write the one dotted note that lasts the same.



dotted note ☐



dotted note ☐

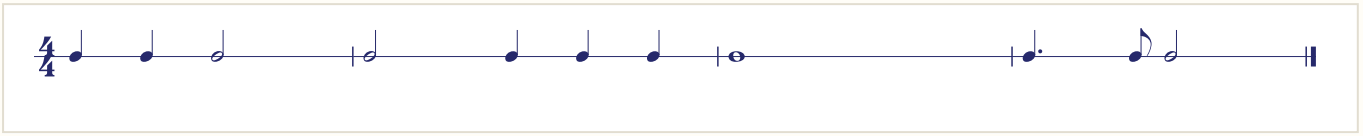


dotted note ☐

2 Spot the mistake

★★☆

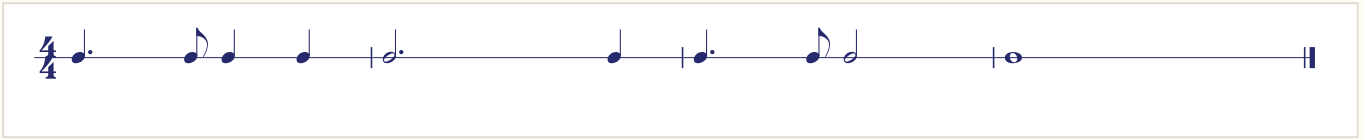
One bar does not add up to four beats. Circle it and correct it.



3 Clap and count

★☆☆

Clap the dotted rhythms, counting the "&" inside each dotted crotchet. Tick a circle each time it is steady.



○ ○ ○ ○ ○

4 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a dotted minim		
a dotted crotchet		
a tie		
a rest of one whole bar		

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · TIME SIGNATURES · LEARN

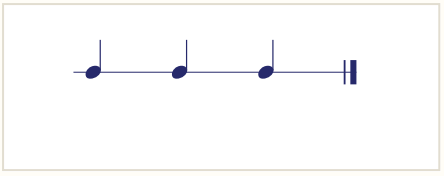
Time signatures

REMEMBER Top number: how many counts in a bar. Bottom number: which note is one count.

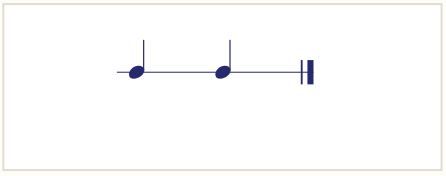
1 Which time signature?

★☆☆

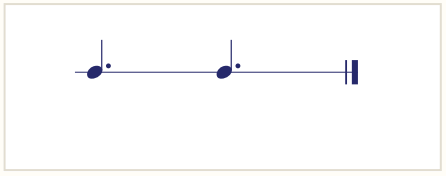
Each line is one full bar. Write a time signature that fits.



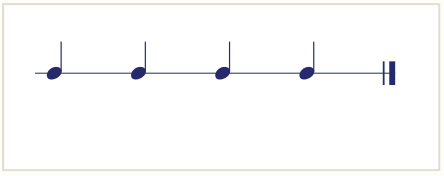
time signature ☐



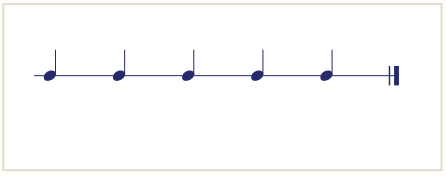
time signature ☐



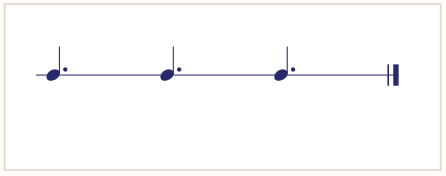
time signature ☐



time signature ☐



time signature ☐



time signature ☐

2 Simple or compound?

★★☆

Circle simple or compound, then write how many beats are in each bar.

$\frac{3}{4}$	simple · compound	beats ☐	$\frac{6}{8}$	simple · compound	beats ☐
$\frac{2}{2}$	simple · compound	beats ☐	$\frac{9}{8}$	simple · compound	beats ☐
$\frac{4}{4}$	simple · compound	beats ☐	$\frac{12}{8}$	simple · compound	beats ☐
$\frac{3}{8}$	simple · compound	beats ☐	$\frac{6}{4}$	simple · compound	beats ☐

3 What does it mean?

★☆☆

Complete each sentence.

In 3/4 there are ☐ beats in a bar, and each beat is a _____ .

In 6/8 there are ☐ beats in a bar, and each beat is a _____ .

C means the same as ☐ ; ¢ means the same as ☐ .

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

TIME · TIME SIGNATURES · USE

Time signatures

REMEMBER In compound time each beat is a dotted note, divided into three.

1 Add the bar lines

★★☆

Draw a bar line after every full bar, and a final bar line at the end.



2 Beam them

★★★

The same six quavers in two time signatures. Join them with beams to show the beats: in twos for 3/4, in threes for 6/8.



3 beats

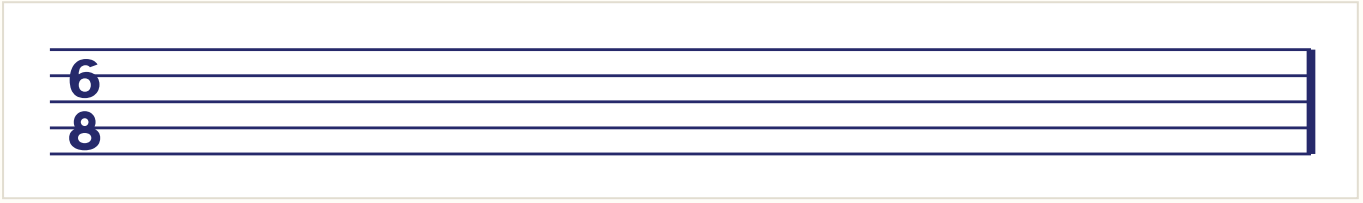


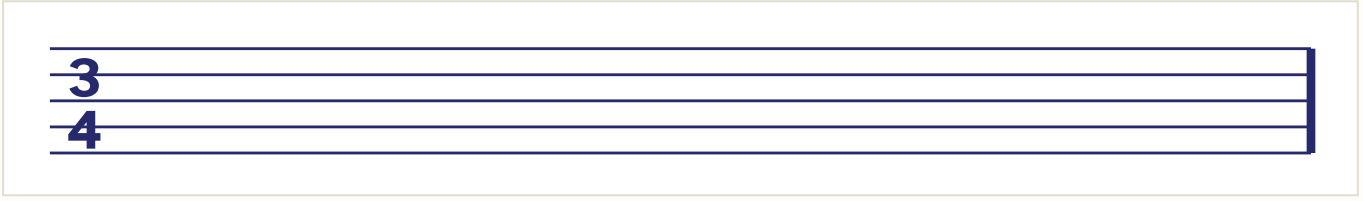
2 beats

3 Make your own

★★★

Write one bar of 6/8 and one bar of 3/4 with six quavers each, beamed correctly. Clap both and feel the difference.





Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · RHYTHM · LEARN

Rhythm

REMEMBER Beams join the notes of one beat, so the beats stay visible.

1 Good grouping?

★★☆

Circle ✓ if the grouping shows the beats, × if it hides one.



✓ ×



✓ ×



✓ ×

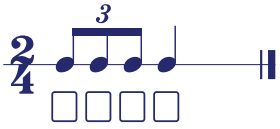


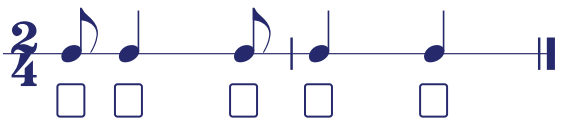
✓ ×

2 Count it

★★☆

Write a count in every box: a triplet, then a syncopation.

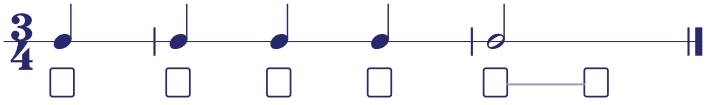




3 The upbeat

★★☆

This piece starts on beat 3. Write a count in every box. Then: how many beats does the last bar need?



beats in the last bar ☐

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

TIME · RHYTHM · USE

Rhythm

REMEMBER Swing: pairs of quavers written evenly, played long–short.

1 Swing ★☆☆

Which line shows how swung quavers are played? Circle A or B, then play both and hear the difference.

A



B



2 Clap and count ★★☆

Clap each line with a metronome while counting aloud. Tick a circle each day it is steady.

6/8



triplets and semiquavers



syncopation



3 In your music ★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
an upbeat (anacrusis)		
a triplet		
a syncopation		
swing marked at the top		

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · REVIEW

Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 13.

1 Name the notes ★☆☆

Write the name of each note.



2 How many beats? ★☆☆

Crotchet = 1 beat.





3 Time signatures ★★☆

Write a time signature for each bar, then circle the compound ones.



time signature ☐



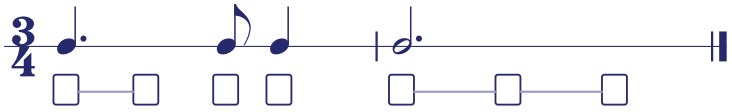
time signature ☐



time signature ☐

4 Count it ★★☆

Write a count in every box.



5 True or false? ★★☆

Circle T or F.

A tie joins two notes of different pitches.	T	F
6/8 has two beats in a bar.	T	F
In 4/4, a beam may cross the middle of the bar.	T	F

Score ☐ **/ 20**

Date _____ Practised ____ times Checked _____

TIME · PROGRESS

My progress

HOW TO USE Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

CONCEPT	I KNOW IT	I CAN WRITE IT	I CAN PLAY IT	HANDBOOK
pulse, tempo and strong beats	☐	☐	☐	p. 36
bar lines and repeat signs	☐	☐	☐	p. 36
note and rest values	☐	☐	☐	p. 37
dots and ties	☐	☐	☐	p. 38
simple time signatures	☐	☐	☐	p. 39
compound time (6/8)	☐	☐	☐	p. 40
grouping with beams	☐	☐	☐	p. 41
upbeats	☐	☐	☐	p. 41
triplets	☐	☐	☐	p. 41
syncopation and swing	☐	☐	☐	p. 42

Teacher's note

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

TIME · ANSWERS

Answers

PAGE	ANSWERS
p. 1	Slow to fast: 60, 76, 92, 120. Strong beats on 1; in 4/4 medium on 3. Signs: bar line, double bar line, final bar line, repeat signs. Count: 1 2 3 · 1–2 3 · 1–2–3.
p. 2	Mistake: bar 3 has 4 beats.
p. 3	Draw it: minim, quaver, dotted minim, semibreve. Table: crotchet 1, minim 2, quaver ½, dotted minim 3, semiquaver ¼. Also called: half note, quarter note, eighth note, sixteenth note.
p. 4	Stems: up on the right below the middle line, down on the left above it, either on it. Rests: minim, crotchet, minim, crotchet.
p. 5	Sums: 1½, 4, 6, 2, 2. Complete: crotchet, crotchet, crotchet, quaver, quaver, quaver.
p. 6	Tie or dot: dotted minim, dotted crotchet, dotted semibreve. Mistake: bar 2 has 5 beats.
p. 8	Beams: 3/4 in three pairs; 6/8 in two groups of three.
p. 7	Time signatures: 3/4, 2/4, 6/8, 4/4, 5/4, 9/8. Compound: 6/8, 9/8, 12/8, 6/4 (beats 2, 3, 4, 2). Simple: 3/4 (3), 2/2 (2), 4/4 (4), 3/8 (3). 3/4: 3 crotchet beats; 6/8: 2 dotted-crotchet beats; C = 4/4, ¢ = 2/2.
p. 9	Grouping: ✓ × ✓ ×. Triplet: 1 & a 2. Syncopation: 1 & & 1 2. Upbeat: 3 · 1 2 3 · 1–2; the last bar needs 2 beats.
p. 10	Swing is played as B.
p. 11	minim, quaver, dotted crotchet, semibreve · 4, 4 · 6/8, 5/4, 9/8 (compound: 6/8 and 9/8) · 1–2 & 3 · 1–2–3 · F, T, F.

Pages with “make your own”, “in your music” and clapping have no single answer: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____ Practised _____ times Checked _____

RHYTHM · STEP 1

Feel the beat

Beat or rhythm?

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 AT THE PIANO FREE PRINTABLE R1-01

Play any piece (or listen to one). Tap your foot on the beat and clap the rhythm of the tune. Then swap: clap the beat, tap the rhythm.

Foot beat, hands rhythm ○ ○ ○

Hands beat, foot rhythm ○ ○ ○

Slow to fast

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R1-02

Number the metronome marks from the slowest (1) to the fastest (4).

♩ = 120	♩ = 60	♩ = 92	♩ = 76
☐	☐	☐	☐

Strong beats

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 WRITE IT R1-03

Each dot is one beat. Circle the strong beat in every bar; in 4/4, also underline the medium beat.

2/4 ● ● | ● ● |

3/4 ● ● ● | ● ● ● |

4/4 ● ● ● ● | ● ● ● ● |

Two, three or four?

★★☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 LISTEN R1-04

Someone plays a piece, or a march, a waltz and a song online. Count along and decide how many beats are in each bar.

MUSIC	BEATS IN A BAR
_____	2 · 3 · 4
_____	2 · 3 · 4
_____	2 · 3 · 4

Tempo ladder

★★☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 CHALLENGE FREE PRINTABLE R1-05

Clap the line while counting aloud. Tick a step each time it is steady, then move the metronome up.



♩ = 60	♩ = 72	♩ = 84	♩ = 96	♩ = 108
○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○

Walk the beat

★☆☆

FEEL THE BEAT LEVEL 0 AT THE PIANO R1-06

Set the metronome to ♩ = 80. Walk one step on every beat, saying the counts. Stop on beat 1 when someone says “freeze”.

2/4 (left, right)	○ ○ ○
3/4 (a step and a sway)	○ ○ ○
4/4	○ ○ ○

RHYTHM · STEP 2

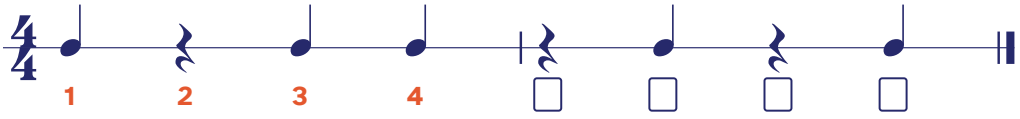
Crotchets and crotchet rests

Count it

★☆☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS LEVEL 0 WRITE IT R2-01

Write a count in every box. Count the rests too: they are beats of silence.

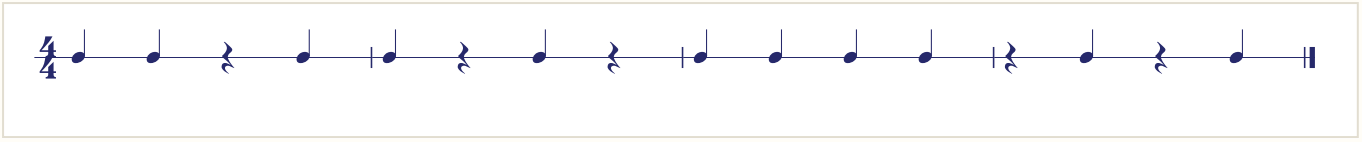


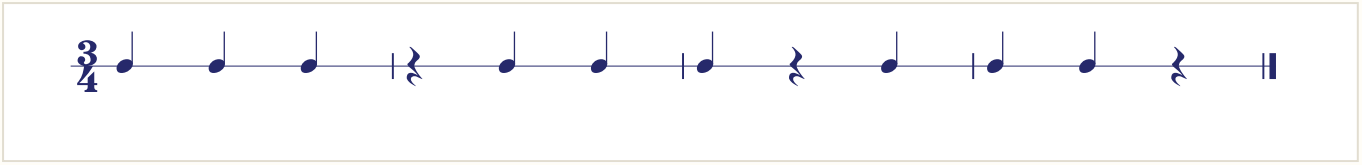
Clap and open

★☆☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · AT THE PIANO · FREE PRINTABLE · R2-02

Clap on every crotchet; open your hands wide on every rest. Count aloud.





Which did you hear?

★★☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · LISTEN · R2-03

Someone claps one rhythm from the row. Circle A, B or C. Then swap roles.

A 

B 

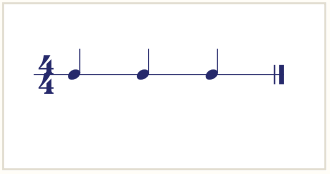
C 

Finish with rests

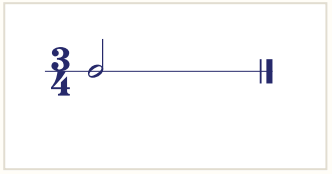
★★☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · WRITE IT · R2-04

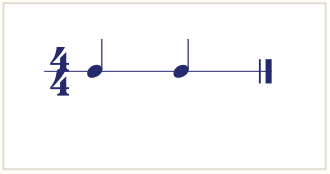
Each bar is short. Complete it with crotchet rests (draw as many as you need).



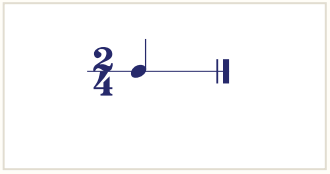
rests ☐



rests ☐



rests ☐



rests ☐

Rhythm echo

★☆☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS · LEVEL 0 · AT THE PIANO · FREE PRINTABLE · R2-05

Someone claps one bar of crotchets and rests; you clap it straight back without a pause. Colour a square for every echo that is exactly right.

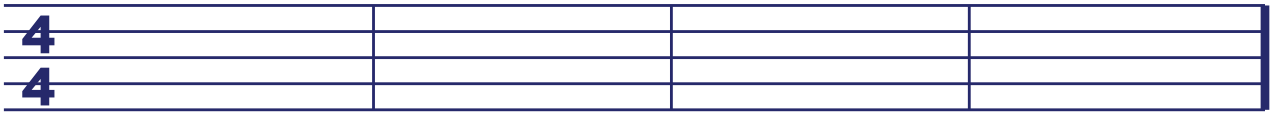
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Rest patterns

★★☆

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS LEVEL 0 MAKE YOUR OWN R2-06

Make four different bars of 4/4 using crotchets and crotchet rests. No two the same. Clap each one.



Two hands

★★★

CROTCHETS AND CROTCHET RESTS LEVEL 0 CHALLENGE R2-07

Right hand plays the top line on one key, left hand the bottom line on another. Slowly, then faster.



right hand



left hand

RHYTHM · STEP 3

Minims and semibreves

Count it

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 WRITE IT R3-01

Write a count in every box: the beat you play, then the beats you hold.

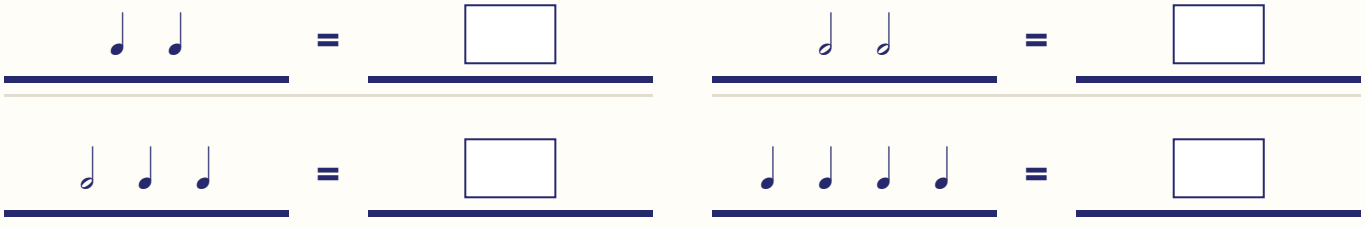


Balance the scales

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R3-02

Write one note on the right so both sides last the same.

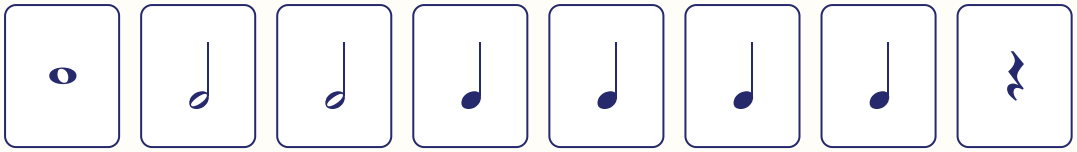


Rhythm dominoes

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R3-03

Use the cards to fill one bar of 4/4 exactly (4 beats). How many different ways can you find? Write each way by drawing the notes.



1 _____ 2 _____

3 _____ 4 _____

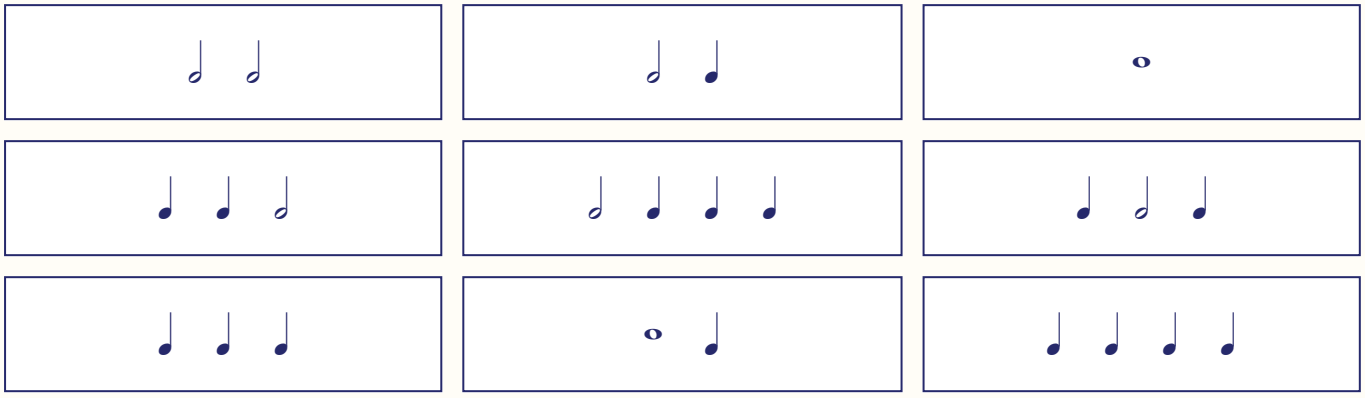
5 _____ 6 _____

Full bar hunt

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 PUZZLE FREE PRINTABLE R3-04

Colour every box that holds exactly four beats.

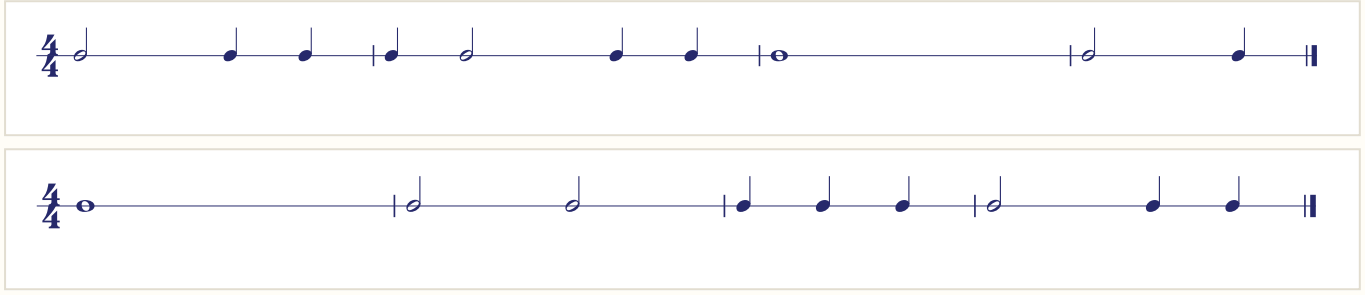


Rhythm detective

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 FIND AND FIX R3-05

Each line has one bar with the wrong number of beats. Circle it and fix it.



Short or long?

★★☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 LISTEN R3-06

Someone claps one rhythm from the row. Circle A, B or C.

A 

B 

C 

Question and answer

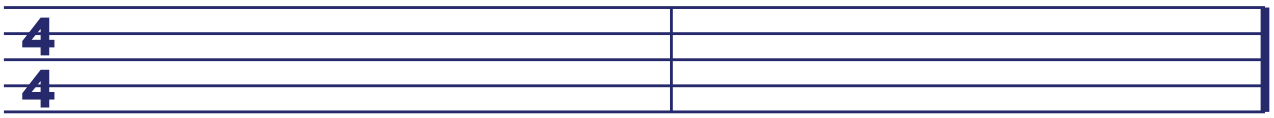
★★★

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 MAKE YOUR OWN R3-07

The first two bars ask a question. Write two bars that answer it, ending on a long note. Play it on one key.



question



In your music

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 YOUR MUSIC R3-08

Find these in a piece you are learning.

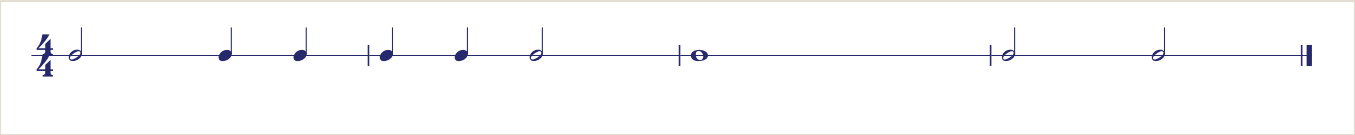
FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a minim		
a semibreve		
a crotchet rest		
a bar of four crotchets		

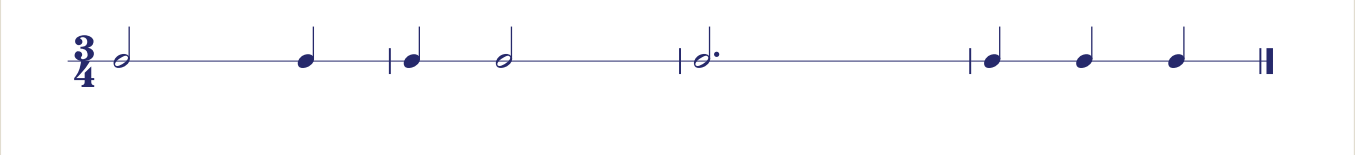
Clap and count

★☆☆

MINIMS AND SEMIBREVES LEVEL 0 AT THE PIANO FREE PRINTABLE R3-09

Clap and count each line, holding your hands together through the long notes.





RHYTHM · STEPS 1–3

Answers

ACTIVITY	ANSWER
R1-02 Slow to fast	60, 76, 92, 120
R1-03 Strong beats	beat 1 of every bar; in 4/4 also beat 3
R2-01 Count it	1 2 3 4 · 1 2 3 4 (rests on 1 and 3)
R2-04 Finish with rests	1 · 1 · 2 · 1 crotchet rests
R3-01 Count it	1–2 3 4 · 1–2–3–4 · 1 2–3 4
R3-02 Balance the scales	minim · semibreve · semibreve · semibreve
R3-03 Rhythm dominoes	e.g. semibreve · two minims · minim + two crotchets · four crotchets · minim + crotchet + crotchet rest …
R3-04 Full bar hunt	boxes 1, 3, 4, 6, 9
R3-05 Rhythm detective	line 1: bar 2 (5 beats) · line 2: bar 3 (3 beats)

FREE RHYTHM SHEET

Feel the beat

1 Beat or rhythm?

★☆☆

Play any piece (or listen to one). Tap your foot on the beat and clap the rhythm of the tune. Then swap: clap the beat, tap the rhythm.

Foot beat, hands rhythm ○ ○ ○

Hands beat, foot rhythm ○ ○ ○

2 Slow to fast

★☆☆

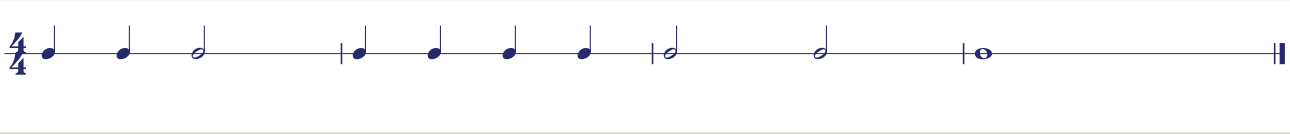
Number the metronome marks from the slowest (1) to the fastest (4).

♩ = 120	♩ = 60	♩ = 92	♩ = 76
☐	☐	☐	☐

3 Tempo ladder

★★☆

Clap the line while counting aloud. Tick a step each time it is steady, then move the metronome up.



♩ = 60	♩ = 72	♩ = 84	♩ = 96	♩ = 108
○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○	○ ○ ○

Answers 2: 60, 76, 92, 120

Free to print and share for teaching. © Piano Butler

FREE RHYTHM SHEET

Crotchets and rests

1 Clap and open

★☆☆

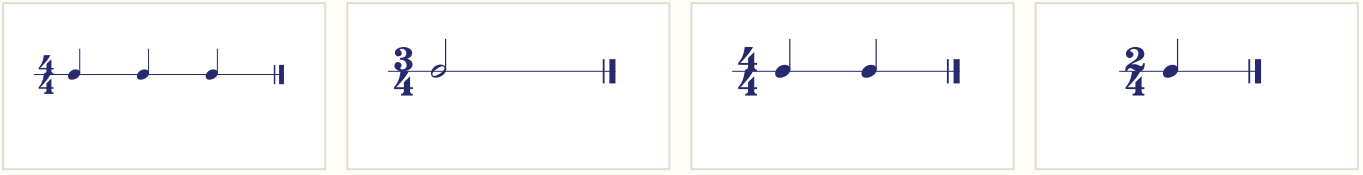
Clap on every crotchet; open your hands wide on every rest. Count aloud.



2 Finish with rests

★★☆

Each bar is short. Complete it with crotchet rests (draw as many as you need).



rests ☐ rests ☐ rests ☐ rests ☐

3 Rhythm echo

★☆☆

Someone claps one bar of crotchets and rests; you clap it straight back without a pause. Colour a square for every echo that is exactly right.

Answers 2: 1 · 1 · 2 · 1 crotchet rests

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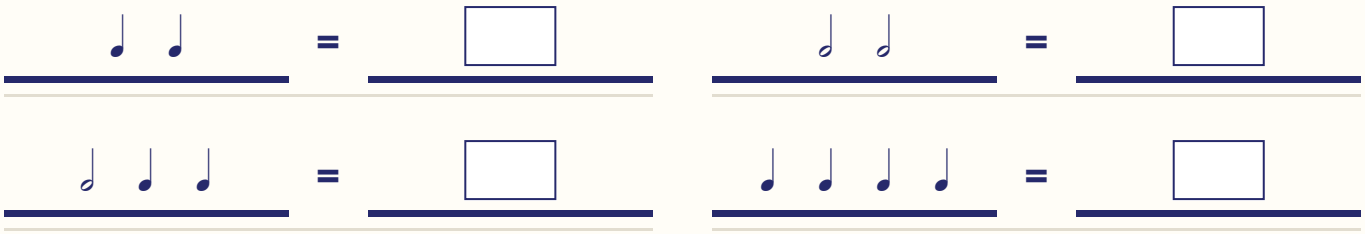
FREE RHYTHM SHEET

Long notes

1 Balance the scales

★☆☆

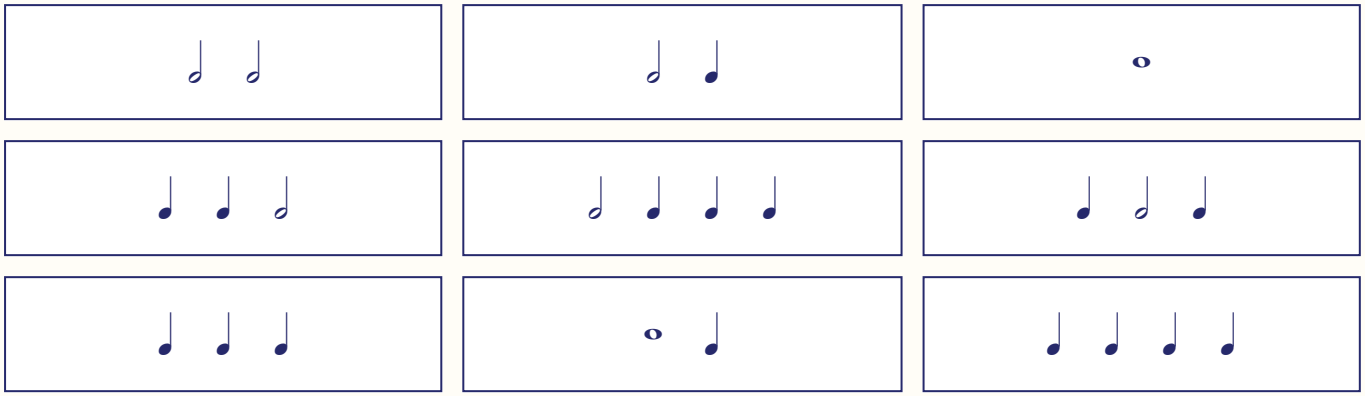
Write one note on the right so both sides last the same.



2 Full bar hunt

★★☆

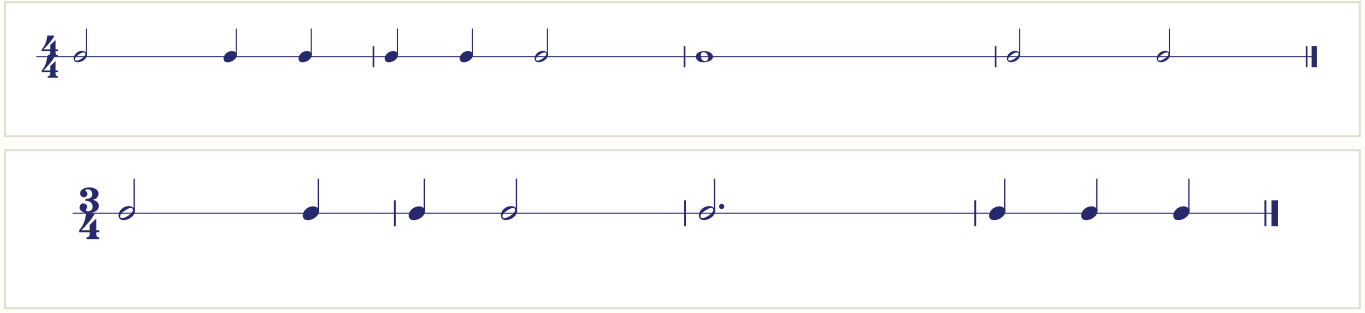
Colour every box that holds exactly four beats.



3 Clap and count

★☆☆

Clap and count each line, holding your hands together through the long notes.



Answers 1: minim · semibreve · semibreve · semibreve · 2: boxes 1, 3, 4, 6, 9

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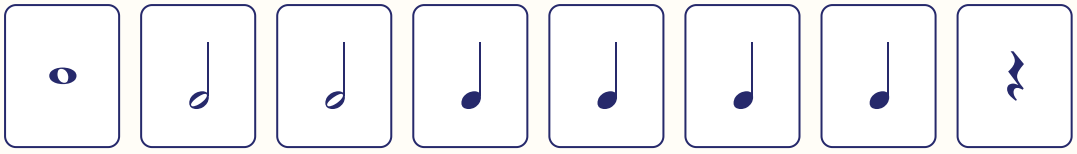
FREE RHYTHM SHEET

Rhythm puzzles

1 Rhythm dominoes

★★☆

Use the cards to fill one bar of 4/4 exactly (4 beats). How many different ways can you find? Write each way by drawing the notes.



1 _____ 2 _____

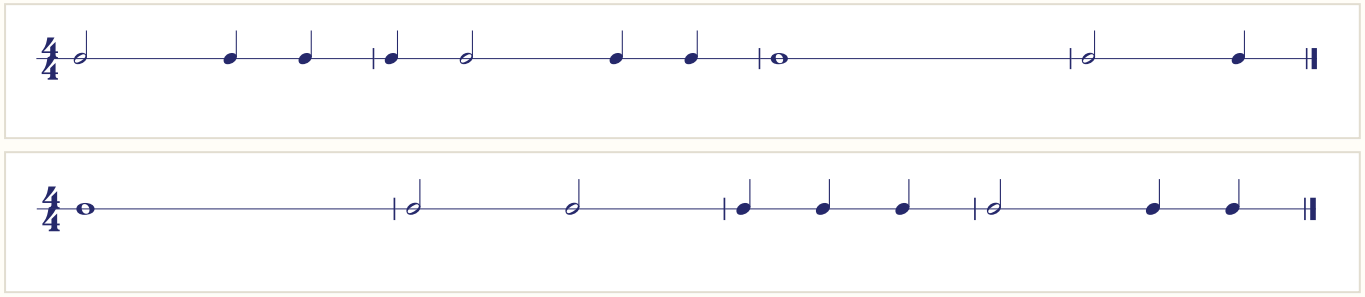
3 _____ 4 _____

5 _____ 6 _____

2 Rhythm detective

★★☆

Each line has one bar with the wrong number of beats. Circle it and fix it.



Answers 1: e.g. semibreve · two minims · minim + two crotchets · four crotchets · minim + crotchet + crotchet rest · … · 2: line 1: bar 2 (5 beats) · line 2: bar 3 (3 beats)

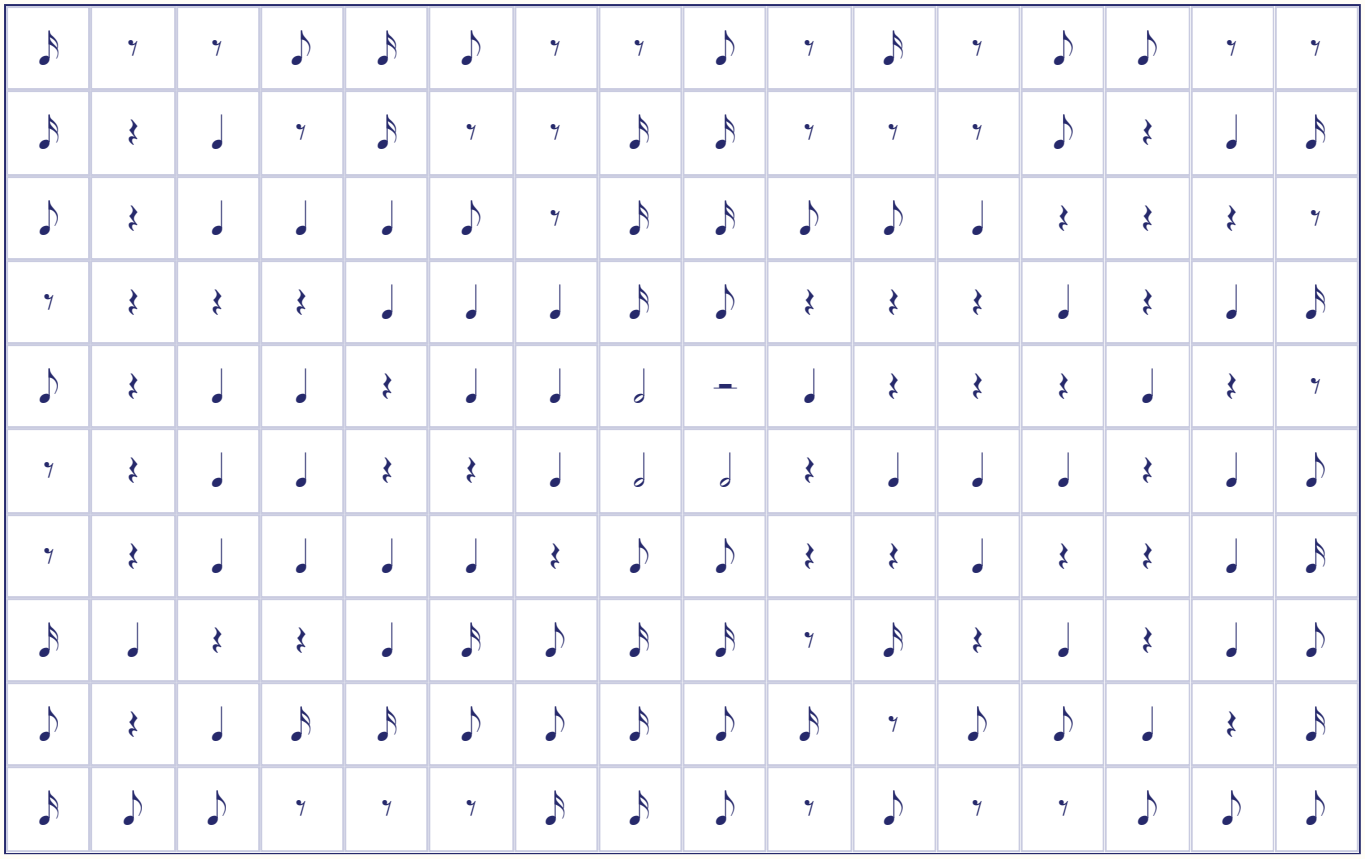
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RHYTHM GAME

Colour by beats

Every square holds a note or a rest. Colour it by how many beats it lasts (crotchet = 1 beat). Something will appear.

1 beat: navy **2 beats: coral** **less than 1 beat: leave white**



Then

Clap the top row from left to right, counting aloud: every note and rest in its place. Then the bottom row, backwards.

Answer, upside down: the Piano Butler's bow tie

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RHYTHM GAME

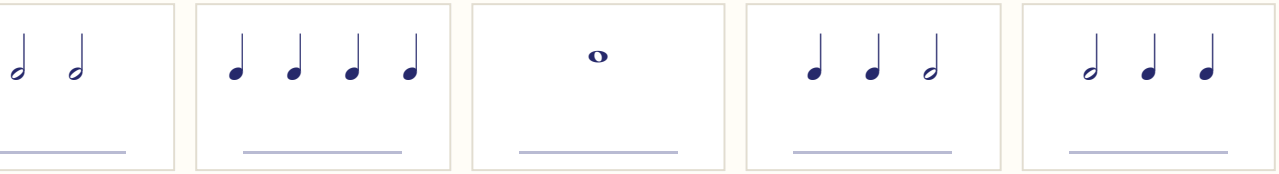
The secret code

Each bar of 4/4 stands for a letter. Clap each bar of the message, find it in the code book, and write its letter underneath.

Code book

P		I	
A		N	
O		T	
E		S	
L		Y	

Message 1



Message 2



Your turn

Write your own name in rhythm code, then give it to a friend to decode.

Answers, upside down: ʎɐlԀ · ONAIԀ

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm bingo

For two to twenty players. The caller cuts out the call cards and claps one at a time (each lasts two beats). Players mark the matching square. Three in a row wins: clap your line back to prove it.

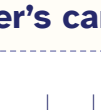
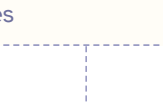
PLAYER CARD A

		
	FREE	
		

PLAYER CARD B

		
	FREE	
		

PLAYER CARD C

		
	FREE	
		

PLAYER CARD D

		
	FREE	
		

Caller's cards

✂ cut along the lines

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RHYTHM GAME

Race to the double bar

Two to four players, one die, a counter each. Roll and move. Clap the rhythm on your square while counting aloud: if another player agrees it was right, stay; if not, go back to where you were. First to the final bar wins.

1 	2 	3 **Rest** miss a turn	4 	5 	6
12 	11 **Repeat** back 3	10 	9 	8 	7 **Pause** roll again
13 	14 	15 **Pause** roll again	16 	17 	18 **Rest** miss a turn
24 **Final bar** you win	23 	22 	21 **Repeat** back 3	20	19

Start on square 1.

Harder: play the rhythm on the piano instead of clapping, at ♩ = 80.

Team game: one claps, the other counts aloud.

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm memory

For two to four players. Cut out the 16 cards and lay them face down. Turn over two: a rhythm and its name and beats make a pair. Clap the rhythm to keep the pair. Most pairs wins.

Cards

✂ cut along the lines

crotchet **1**			
minim **2**			
	dotted crotchet + quaver **2**	two quavers **1**	
dotted minim **3**	semibreve **4**	crotchet rest **1**	minim rest **2**

Harder: play without the names, matching rhythms that last the same number of beats.

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm dominoes

Cut out the dominoes. Join them in a ring: a rhythm must touch a number that matches how many beats it lasts. Clap each rhythm as you place it.

Dominoes

✂ cut along the lines

1	♩ ♩	2	𝅗𝅥.	3	𝅝
4	♩. ♪	2	♩ ♩	3	𝄽
1	𝅝	4	♩ ♩ ♩	3	♩ ♩
2	𝅗𝅥 𝅗𝅥	4	𝄽	1	♩ ♩ ♩
3	𝅗𝅥. ♩	4	♩. ♪	2	♩

Two players: share out the dominoes and take turns to add one to either end. If you cannot go, clap the last rhythm and pass.

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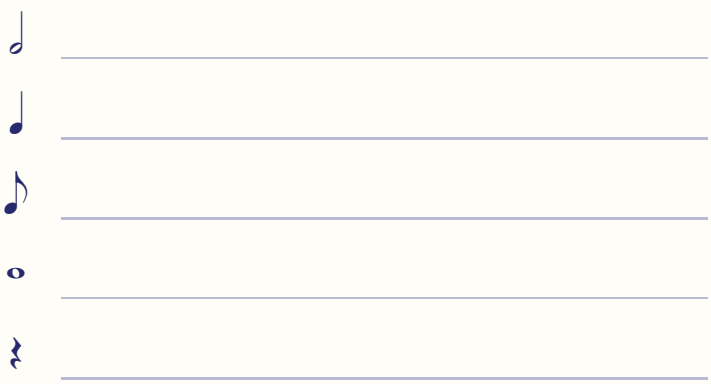
RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm word search

Twelve rhythm words are hidden across, down and diagonally. First name the five pictures, then find all twelve words.

C	Q	C	C	R	O	T	C	H	E	T	C	G
V	H	U	A	Y	N	N	Y	R	E	V	S	V
E	O	F	A	E	L	H	Y	H	G	F	U	G
T	O	S	Y	V	C	P	B	D	D	B	B	T
E	I	H	O	I	E	B	P	Y	S	L	E	T
M	F	C	E	H	S	R	A	U	Y	Y	A	C
P	M	I	N	I	M	I	G	R	G	T	T	A
O	C	I	P	R	H	B	B	F	L	I	N	T
V	S	E	M	I	B	R	E	V	E	E	E	C
N	E	R	M	T	T	V	E	V	B	A	S	N
P	U	L	S	E	L	B	A	Y	C	S	C	L
M	E	E	C	T	R	I	P	L	E	T	C	R
U	R	N	B	E	M	N	C	S	D	O	T	C

Name them



Also find

TIE · DOT · BAR · BEAT · PULSE · TEMPO · TRIPLET

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm sudoku

Each row, each column and each 2 × 2 box must hold all four rhythms once. Draw the missing ones, then clap each row: it makes two bars of 4/4.



PUZZLE 1 ★

♩ ♩			
	♩ 𝄽		
𝅗𝅥		♩ 𝄽	♪ ♪ ♩
♩ 𝄽		𝅗𝅥	♩ ♩

PUZZLE 2 ★★

𝅗𝅥	♩ ♩		
	𝅗𝅥	♪ ♪ ♩	
	♩ 𝄽		𝅗𝅥

PUZZLE 3 ★★★ (ONLY FIVE CLUES)

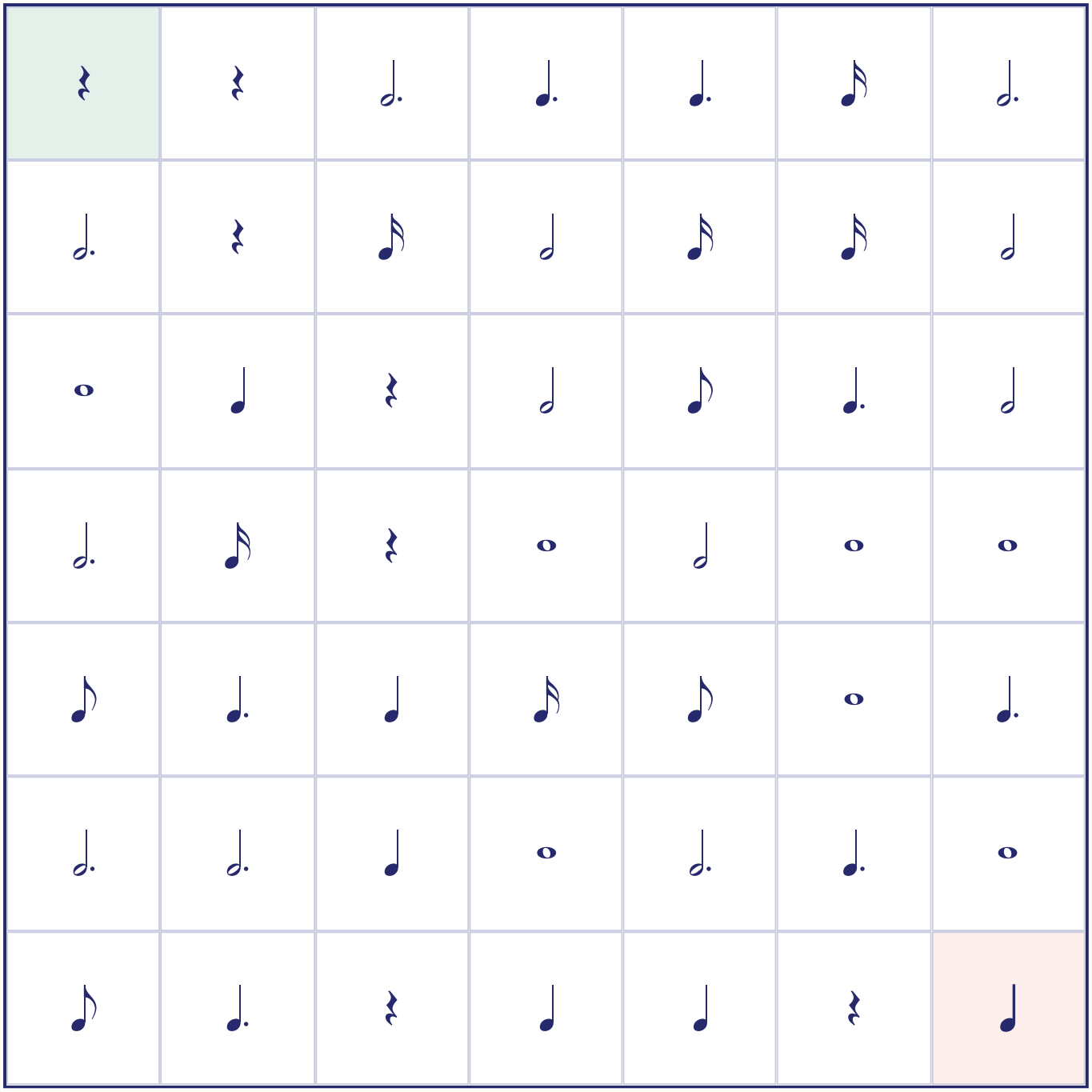
		𝅗𝅥	
	♩ ♩		♪ ♪ ♩
♪ ♪ ♩	♩ 𝄽		

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RHYTHM GAME

One-beat path

Get from START to FINISH stepping only on squares worth exactly one beat (a crotchet or a crotchet rest). Move up, down, left or right, never diagonally. Then clap your path as one long rhythm.



START: top left **FINISH: bottom right**

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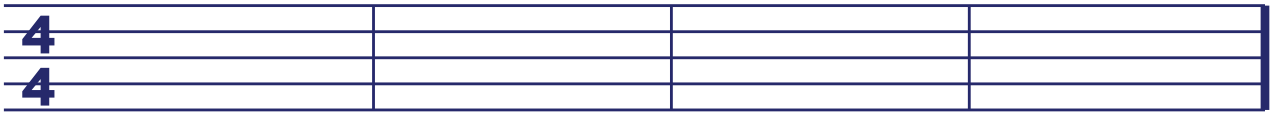
RHYTHM GAME

The dice composer

Two hundred years ago, composers sold dice games for writing music by chance. Roll a die four times: the first roll chooses bar 1, the second bar 2, and so on. Copy your bars below, clap them, then play them on one key, or on a five-finger scale.

	BAR 1	BAR 2	BAR 3	BAR 4
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

My piece



Clapped it · Played it · Played it to someone

There are 6 × 6 × 6 × 6 = 1,296 possible pieces.

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RHYTHM GAME

The rhythm café

Every dish on the menu has a rhythm: say it and clap it. Then order a meal that fills exactly one bar of 4/4 (4 beats). Write your order and its rhythm, and clap it to the waiter.

Café Rubato · Menu

Tea		*tea*
Juice		*juice*
Coffee		*cof-fee*
Cocoa		*co-coa*
Lemonade		*lem-on-ade*
Pancakes		*pan-cakes*
Ice cream		*ice cream*
Watermelon		*wa-ter-mel-on*
Pie		*pie… (long)*

My orders

1 _____ _____

2 _____ _____

3 _____ _____

Make your own menu: your favourite foods, or your family's names.

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RHYTHM GAME

Rhythm escape room

You are locked in the practice room. Each lock gives one digit. Solve all four and write the code on the door to escape.

LOCK 1



How many beats in this bar?

LOCK 2



How many rests?

LOCK 3



Beats in a dotted minim?

LOCK 4

How many quavers make a semibreve?

The door

Answer, upside down: 8 ε ε 4

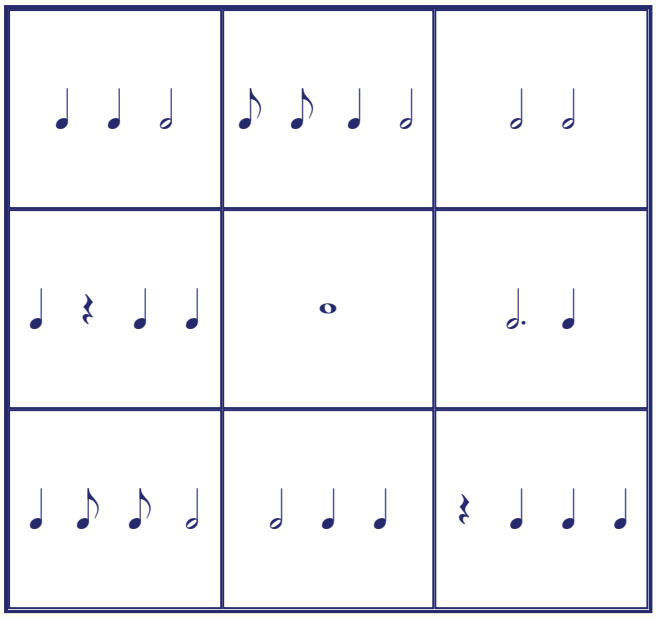
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RHYTHM GAME

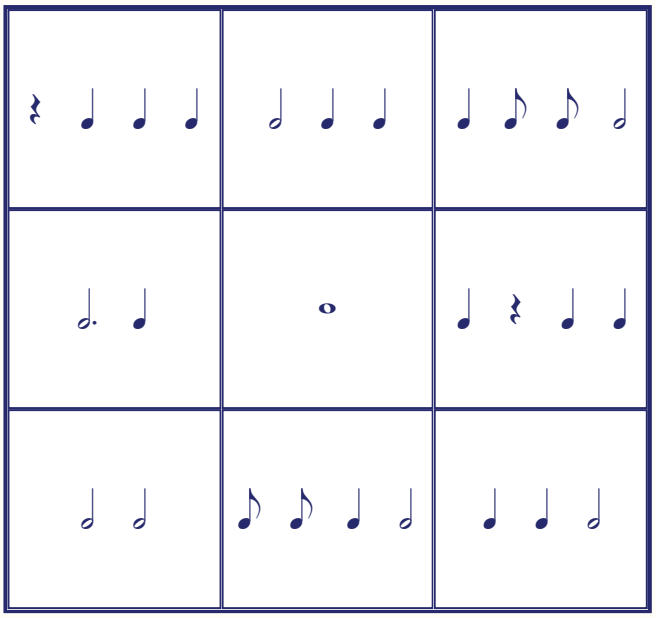
Rhythm noughts and crosses

Two players. To claim a square, clap its rhythm correctly while counting aloud; your partner judges. Claimed: draw your O or X. Three in a row wins.

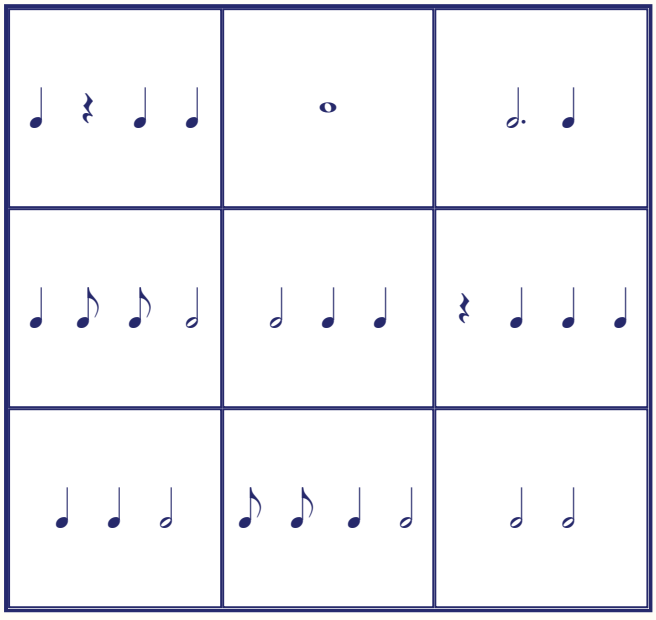
GAME 1: CLAP



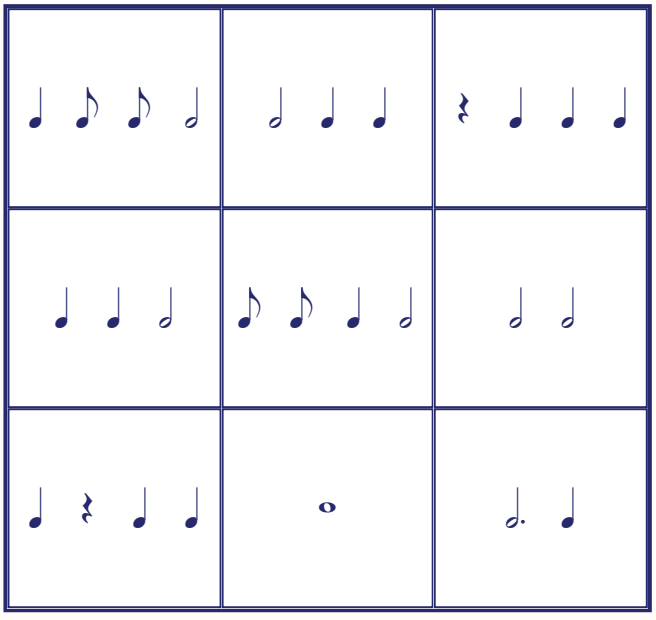
GAME 2: CLAP



GAME 3: PLAY ON ONE KEY



GAME 4: PLAY IT, EYES CLOSED



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